

Northwind Retail — Customer Policy Handbook

Revision 7.2, effective 1 March 2026.

This handbook sets out the policies governing purchases, returns, shipping, warranty and support for all Northwind Retail customers.

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Questions about this handbook should be directed to the Customer Operations team.

Refunds and Returns

Domestic orders may be returned for a full refund within 30 days of the delivery date.

International purchases have a longer window of 45 days, measured from the date the carrier records delivery in the destination country.

A restocking fee of 15% applies to opened items returned without a manufacturing fault. Unopened items are never subject to a restocking fee.

Refunds are issued to the original payment method and take between 5 and 10 business days to appear, depending on the issuing bank.

Items purchased during a clearance event are final sale and cannot be returned unless faulty.

Return shipping is paid by the customer except where the item is faulty, damaged in transit, or was sent in error.

Shipping and Delivery

Standard delivery takes 5 to 7 business days and costs 4.99 GBP.

Express delivery arrives within 2 business days and costs 12.99 GBP. Orders placed after 14:00 are dispatched the following business day.

Standard delivery is free on all orders over 75 GBP.

International shipping is available to 42 countries. Delivery takes 7 to 21 business days and any import duty is the responsibility of the recipient.

Northwind Retail does not deliver to PO boxes or freight-forwarding addresses.

A tracking number is issued by email once the parcel leaves the distribution centre in Reading.

Product Warranty

All products carry a standard manufacturer warranty of 24 months from the date of purchase.

Customers who register a product within 60 days of purchase receive an extended warranty of 36 months at no additional cost.

The warranty covers manufacturing defects and component failure under normal use. It does not cover accidental damage, liquid ingress, cosmetic wear, or damage caused by unauthorised repair.

Warranty claims require proof of purchase. An order number is sufficient; a printed receipt is not required.

Where a product cannot be repaired, Northwind Retail will replace it with an equivalent model. Where no equivalent exists, a credit note for the original purchase price is issued.

Damaged and Incorrect Items

Damage in transit must be reported within 7 days of delivery.

Reports must include at least two photographs: one of the item and one of the outer packaging as received.

Incorrect items should not be returned before contacting support. A prepaid return label is issued once the error is confirmed, usually within one business day.

Replacements for damaged items are dispatched by express delivery at no cost to the customer.

Claims made after the 7 day window may still be considered where the damage could not reasonably have been discovered earlier, at the discretion of the Customer Operations team.

Data Retention and Privacy

Order records are retained for 24 months after the final interaction on the account, after which they are anonymised.

Payment card details are never stored by Northwind Retail. Card data is handled entirely by the payment processor.

Customers may request a copy of their personal data at any time. Requests are fulfilled within 30 days.

Marketing consent is opt-in and can be withdrawn from the account settings page or by replying STOP to any message.

The Data Protection Officer can be reached at privacy@northwind-retail.example.

Customer Support

Support is available Monday to Friday, 09:00 to 18:00 GMT, excluding public holidays.

Tickets receive a first response within 4 business hours. Complex cases are escalated to a specialist within one business day.

Live chat is available during support hours. Email is monitored continuously but answered during support hours only.

A complaint that cannot be resolved by the support team is escalated to the Customer Operations manager, who responds within 5 business days.

Support is provided in English, French and German.

Loyalty Programme

Customers earn 1 point for every 1 GBP spent, excluding delivery charges.

The programme has three tiers. Silver begins at 500 points, Gold at 2,000 points, and Platinum at 5,000 points.

Silver members receive free standard delivery. Gold members additionally receive early access to sales. Platinum members receive free express delivery and a dedicated support line.

Points expire 18 months after they are earned if the account has had no qualifying purchase in that period.

Tier status is reviewed every 12 months and does not decrease by more than one tier at a review.